Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-17

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 27:1-24

1 And the children of Israel, according to their number, the heads of fathers' houses, the captains of thousands and hundreds and their officers, served the king in every matter of the military divisions. These divisions came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year, each division having twenty-four thousand.

2 Over the first division for the first month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel, and in his division were twenty-four thousand;

3 he was of the children of Perez, and the chief of all the captains of the army for the first month.

4 Over the division of the second month was Dodai an Ahohite, and of his division Mikloth also was the leader; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

5 The third captain of the army for the third month was Benaiah, the son of Jehoiada the priest, who was chief; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

6 This was the Benaiah who was mighty among the thirty, and was over the thirty; in his division was Ammizabad his son.

7 The fourth captain for the fourth month was Asahel the brother of Joab, and Zebadiah his son after him; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

8 The fifth captain for the fifth month was Shamhuth the Izrahite; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

9 The sixth captain for the sixth month was Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

10 The seventh captain for the seventh month was Helez the Pelonite, of the children of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

11 The eighth captain for the eighth month was Sibbechai the Hushathite, of the Zarhites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

12 The ninth captain for the ninth month was Abiezer the Anathothite, of the Benjamites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

13 The tenth captain for the tenth month was Maharai the Netophathite, of the Zarhites; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

14 The eleventh captain for the eleventh month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the children of Ephraim; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

15 The twelfth captain for the twelfth month was Heldai the Netophathite, of Othniel; in his division were twenty-four thousand.

16 Furthermore, over the tribes of Israel: the officer over the Reubenites was Eliezer the son of Zichri; over the Simeonites, Shephatiah the son of Maachah;

17 over the Levites, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel; over the Aaronites, Zadok;

18 over Judah, Elihu, one of David’ s brothers; over Issachar, Omri the son of Michael;

19 over Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of Obadiah; over Naphtali, Jerimoth the son of Azriel;

20 over the children of Ephraim, Hoshea the son of Azaziah; over the half-tribe of Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiah;

21 over the half-tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah; over Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner;

22 over Dan, Azarel the son of Jeroham. These were the leaders of the tribes of Israel.

23 But David did not take the number of those twenty years old and under, because the Lord had said He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens.

24 Joab the son of Zeruiah began a census, but he did not finish, for wrath came upon Israel because of this census; nor was the number recorded in the account of the chronicles of King David.

II. Key Summary

• The heads of fathers' houses, the captains of thousands and hundreds, and their officers served the king in twelve divisions of twenty-four thousand each, coming in and going out month by month; every month from the first to the twelfth had its own captain, such as Benaiah, who was mighty among the thirty, and Asahel, whose son Zebadiah

came after him.

• Verses 16–22 list the leaders over the tribes of Israel, such as Elihu, one of David's brothers, over Judah; Zadok over the Aaronites; and Jaasiel the son of Abner over Benjamin.

• David did not take the number of those twenty years old and under, because the Lord had said He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens; Joab began a census but did not finish, for wrath came upon Israel, and the number was not recorded in the chronicles of King David.

III. Passage Analysis

Twelve Months, Twelve Divisions Taking Turns

> The militia was divided into twelve divisions, each serving one month a year. This arrangement both kept the people from being worn out and gave all of them the chance to train and serve; and whenever an emergency arose, the whole people could be mobilized. [1]

Verse 1 says the divisions "came in and went out month by month throughout all the months of the year," and verses 2–15 run from the first month to the twelfth, with twenty-four thousand in every division. Across the twelve months, every division had its own month.

Countless Because God Promised

> To the general Oriental prejudice against numbering possessions, etc., there was added in the case of the Jews a special objection - a feeling that it would be irreverent to attempt to count what God had promised should be countless. [2]

David did not number those twenty and under, and the reason the text gives is that "the Lord had said He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens" (v. 23); Joab began a census, wrath came upon Israel, he did not finish, and the number was never recorded in the chronicles of King David (v. 24). How many Israel would become was the Lord's promise.

IV. Reflection Question

The last time you stopped to count how much you "have," what were you counting? And after you counted, what did you do?

Joab began a census, did not finish, and the number was never recorded in the chronicles of King David (v. 24); how many Israel would become, the Lord had already promised: "He would multiply Israel like the stars of the heavens" (v. 23). The New Testament says we are "being fitted together" in Christ and grow "into a holy temple in the Lord" (Eph. 2:21) [1].

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), "Gleanings on 1 Chronicles 27" (A Comprehensive Interpretation of 1 Chronicles), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%201Chro/13GT27.htm

[2] BibleHub.com, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (1 Chronicles 27:23), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/1_chronicles/27-23.htm